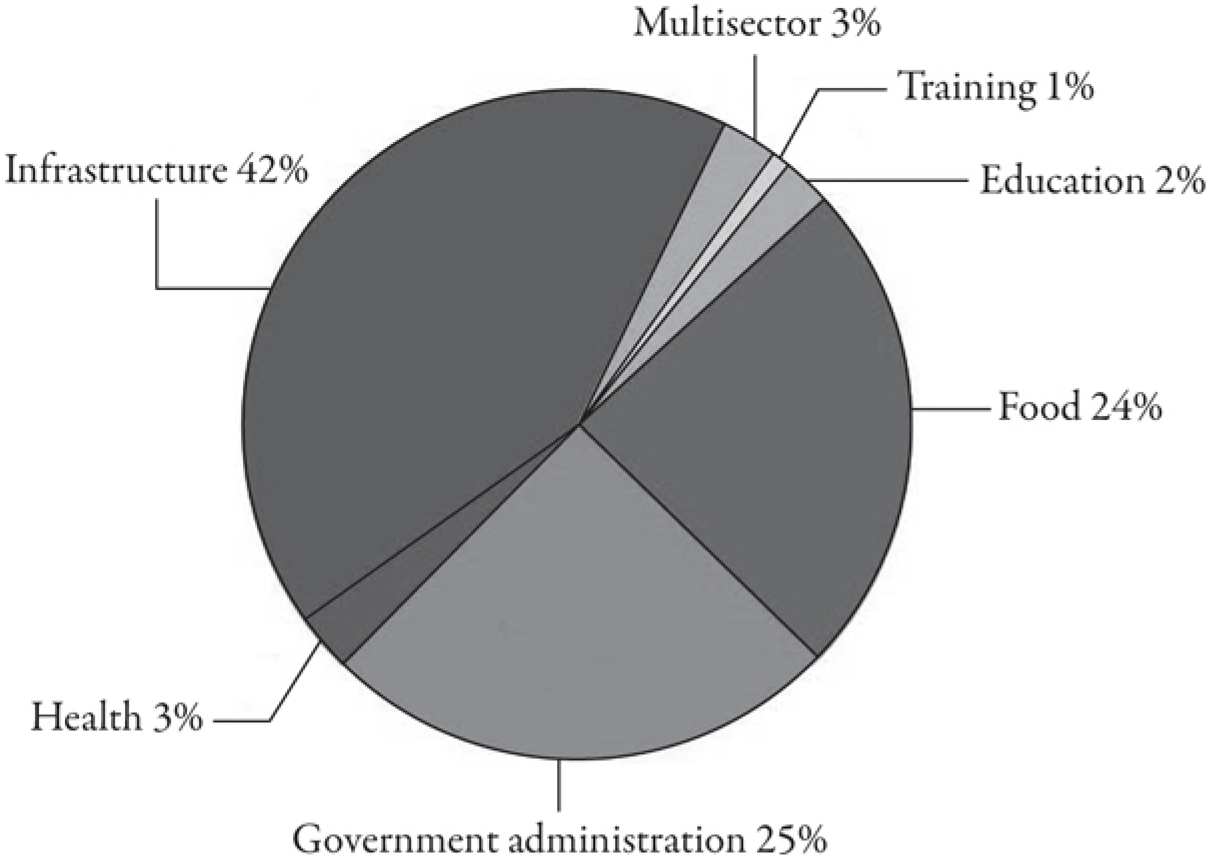

Graph 2: Sectoral breakdown of India's development cooperation with Afghanistan[27]

The scale at which India expanded its presence across Afghanistan after the ouster of the Taliban betrayed its regional aspirations. In a confidential diplomatic cable, the US ambassador to India, David Mulford, noted that India's ever expanding strategic presence offered a terrific opportunity for the US to collaborate with New Delhi in Afghanistan. The '(nice) big brother' he told his bosses, 'was here to stay'.[28] By December 2005, seven public and nine private sector Indian companies were involved in air ticket sales, TV transmission, microwave transmission, power transmission, construction of common facility and tool room centre (Rs. 401.08 lakhs), dam construction, telecom, banking, consultancy, and offering cold storage facilities in Afghanistan, employing a total of 798 employees.[29] The Self Employed Women's Organisation (SEWA), with support from India's Ministry of Women's Affairs, began imparting vocational training to nearly 3,000 Afghan women in *Bagh-e-Zanana* (a park for women and children).[30] Media cooperation between the two countries also increased